

The Prophetic Night

40 Habits for Sleep, Rest, and the Last Third

Sleep is one of the quiet mercies you were handed before you ever earned it. Every night your body is set down, your senses are folded away, and something you did not build and cannot fully see goes to work repairing you. The Qur'an calls your sleep a rest and the night a covering, and the Prophet ﷺ treated the hours before bed not as leftover time but as an act of worship with a shape to it: a washing, a posture, a word on the lips, a heart turned toward the last third. This book takes that shape and lays it beside what modern sleep science has slowly uncovered, and finds the two saying the same thing in two languages. Forty small habits. The night, rebuilt the way it was meant to be lived.

Introduction: The Night You Were Given

It is 11:40 at night. You prayed Isha hours ago. The house has finally gone quiet, the phone is warm in your hand, and you are telling yourself this is the only hour of the day that belongs to you. Forty minutes later the feed has given you nothing you actually wanted, Fajr is seven hours away, and tomorrow has already been made a little smaller.

We treat the night as the part of the day that does not count. The real living happens in the light, and sleep is the tax we pay to get back to it. So we trim it, borrow against it, and scroll past its edges, and we wonder why

the mornings feel like debts.

Revelation never spoke about the night that way. “It is He who made for you the night to rest in and the day to see by”. “And We made your sleep a means of rest, and We made the night as a covering”. The night in the Qur’an is not empty. It is a garment pulled over a tired world, and sleep inside it is a mercy with a purpose.

Science arrived at the same door from the other side. For most of the last century, researchers assumed sleep was the brain switching off. It turns out to be the opposite. While you lie still, the brain is filing the day into memory, washing itself of waste, and re-tuning the emotions that the day left raw (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch6/8/10). Nothing is idle in there. The stillness is the work.

That is the quiet claim of this book. The Prophet ﷺ readied himself for the night with a deliberate care, and fourteen centuries later the laboratory keeps confirming the wisdom of what he did. He slept early; we now know the early night carries the deepest, most restorative sleep. He washed before bed; we now know a cooling body falls asleep faster and sleeps deeper. He guarded the hour after Isha from idle noise; we now know light and stimulation in that last hour steal the sleep that follows. He rose in the last third; we now know the pre-dawn hours are when the sleeping mind is most tender and the waking one most clear.

The promise here is simple. Forty habits, small enough to start tonight, each one a prophetic practice with the science standing quietly behind it. You do not need all forty at once. Pick one. Let it settle. The night rewards the patient more than the ambitious.

And know what you are actually doing when you pick one. You are not chasing a sleep score. You are becoming a person whose night belongs to Allah: the one who lies down clean, wakes grateful, and keeps a quiet appointment before dawn that no one else knows about.

A word on how to read the sources. Every prophetic practice in this book is tied to a Qur'anic verse or a hadith, and every one of those is marked so a human reviewer can confirm it before this book is published. Nothing here is invented, and where a narration is less firmly established, it is described gently and flagged rather than asserted. The science is drawn from a single careful source and paired honestly, never stretched past what it says.

Let us rebuild the night.

Section One: The Wind-Down

Guarding the last hour, and letting the day come to rest

The night does not begin when your head touches the pillow. It begins an hour earlier, in how you close the day. The Prophet ﷺ gave the end of the evening a clear boundary, and sleep science has found that same boundary to be one of the most powerful levers we have.

Habit 1: Sleep early, soon after Isha

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ disliked staying awake in idle talk after the night prayer and disliked sleeping before it. He preferred that the believer pray Isha and then go to rest.

The Science. The early night is not interchangeable with the late night. Sleep is governed by two systems working together: a roughly twenty-four-hour internal clock, and a rising “sleep pressure” built by a chemical called adenosine that accumulates the longer you are awake (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch2). Going to bed early rides both of these at their fullest, which is why the first hours of the night carry the largest share of deep, restorative sleep. Push your bedtime late and you shave those hours off the front.

Do this tonight. Set a “lights out” time that lets you be in bed within an hour of praying Isha, and treat it as fixed as the prayer itself.

Habit 2: End the day’s talk and turn to dhikr

The Sunnah. The dislike of pointless conversation after Isha was not about silence for its own sake. The Prophet ﷺ would speak with his family and see to what mattered, then let the night close. Idle talk that eats the hours of rest was what he set aside.

The Science. A racing, stimulated mind is one of the most common thieves of sleep onset. The single most reliable pre-sleep instruction in the clinical literature is to relax before bed, letting arousal fall rather than climb in the final hour (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 8). Winding the mind down is not wasted time; it is the runway.

Do this tonight. In the last hour, close the group chat and the news feed and give ten unhurried minutes to remembrance instead; the tasbih of Habit 5 is a ready place to begin. Let the last input of your day be calm, not charged.

Habit 3: Perform wudu before you lie down

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ said that when you go to your bed, perform the ablution as you would for prayer, then lie down. He made washing part of the act of going to sleep.

The Science. Cool, clean water on the face, hands, and feet does something the body reads as a signal. Sleep onset is helped by a gentle drop in core temperature, and warming then cooling the skin’s surface, especially the hands and feet, helps the core shed heat and slip toward sleep (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13). Wudu is a nightly cue of exactly this kind.

Do this tonight. Make your last act before bed a full wudu, unhurried, and lie down in that state.

Habit 4: Finish your meal well before bed

The Sunnah. Moderation with food is a thread running through the Prophet's ﷺ life; he warned against filling the stomach and taught that a few morsels to keep the back straight are enough. This restraint is part of honoring the body, which has a right over you.

The Science. A heavy meal or a large volume of fluid close to bedtime works against sleep, loading the body with digestion and interruption when it should be settling (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Appendix Tip 5). The body cannot power down cleanly while it is still at work on dinner.

Do this tonight. Leave a clear gap between your last real meal and your bed, and keep the late snack and the large drink out of the final stretch.

Habit 5: Settle the heart with tasbih before sleep

The Sunnah. When Fatima asked the Prophet ﷺ for help with the labor of her household, he taught her and Ali a remembrance to say on going to bed: to glorify Allah, praise Him, and proclaim His greatness a set number of times. He offered dhikr as the thing to reach for at the edge of sleep.

The Science. Bedtime worry and a mind that will not stop are among the most common drivers of insomnia, and a calm, repeated pre-sleep routine reduces that arousal and eases the mind toward sleep (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 8). A fixed sequence of words is a well-worn path the mind can follow down into rest.

Do this tonight. As you lie down, let a short, steady dhikr be the last thing on your tongue, repeated slowly until it carries you off.

Habit 6: Build one calm, repeatable closing ritual

The Sunnah. The Prophet's ﷺ nights were not improvised. He had an order to them: the washing, the dusting of the bed, the posture, the recitation, the words of submission said last of all. The night had a shape, and the shape was kept.

The Science. The brain learns by association. A consistent set of cues performed in the same order each night becomes a signal that sleep is coming, and the body begins to prepare before you even lie down (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 8). The ritual is not decoration. It is training.

Do this tonight. Choose three or four of the habits in this book and do them in the same order every night. Let repetition turn them into a doorway your body knows.

Section Two: The Bed & the Body

The posture, the room, and the physical shape of rest

The Prophet ﷺ paid attention to the small physical details of lying down: which side, where the hand rests, the state of the bed, the light in the room. None of it was fussiness. Each detail turns out to touch something the body needs.

Habit 7: Dust off your bed before lying down

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ instructed that when one of you comes to his bed, he should dust it off with the inside of his garment before lying down, and mention the name of Allah, for he does not know what came onto it after he left.

The Science. Sleep is protected by a clean, orderly, comfortable sleeping surface and environment; small discomforts and disturbances fragment the night without our fully waking to notice them (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). Tending the bed each night is a habit of care for the place where a third of your life is spent.

Do this tonight. Before you climb in, sweep the bed clean with your hand, say bismillah, and lie down in a space you have deliberately prepared.

Habit 8: Lie down on your right side, hand under your cheek

The Sunnah. After wudu, the Prophet ﷺ taught, lie down on your right side. He himself, when he went to bed, would place his right hand under his cheek. It was his settled posture for sleep.

The Science. Beyond any single posture, a fixed, repeated way of lying down becomes one of the conditioned cues the brain uses to trigger the descent into sleep; consistency in the approach to sleep is itself restorative (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). There is something in the body that recognizes the shape: the turn onto the side, the weight of the head finding the hand, the same small settling every night. That recognition is the beginning of sleep.

Do this tonight. Turn onto your right side, rest your hand beneath your cheek, and let that be your fixed shape for sleep every night.

Habit 9: Keep your room cool

The Sunnah. There is no specific narration prescribing a room temperature, so this sits under a general principle: the body is an amanah, a trust, and creating the conditions that let it rest well is part of honoring that trust. The Prophet ﷺ chose simple, cool, uncluttered sleeping conditions.

The Science. A cool room is one of the most underused sleep aids we have. The body needs to lower its core temperature by roughly one degree to fall and stay asleep, and a bedroom around eighteen degrees Celsius, about sixty-five Fahrenheit, is close to ideal for most people (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 10). Most bedrooms are kept too warm for good sleep.

Do this tonight. Drop the thermostat a few degrees before bed and let the room run cooler than feels obvious, giving the body the cool it was built to sleep in.

Habit 10: Take a warm wash before bed

The Sunnah. Washing before sleep was the Prophet's ﷺ practice, whether the wudu already mentioned or a fuller washing when needed. Cleanliness at the day's close was part of how he readied himself for rest.

The Science. A warm bath or shower before bed helps sleep, and the mechanism is not the warmth itself but the cooling that follows: bringing blood to the skin's surface lets the body radiate heat afterward, dropping the core temperature and deepening the slow-wave sleep that follows (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 9). The warmth is the setup; the cooling is the payoff.

Do this tonight. If the night allows, take a warm shower before bed, then step into a cool room and let your body do the rest.

Habit 11: Lighten the bedding, let the body cool

The Sunnah. This falls under the same general principle of moderation and care for the body. The Prophet's ﷺ bedding was famously simple; excess and heaviness were not his way, in this as in everything.

The Science. Overheating under heavy bedding is a common, quiet disruptor of sleep, because it blocks the core cooling that sleep depends on. Allowing the hands and feet to stay uncovered, or using lighter covers,

helps the body vent heat and hold onto deep sleep (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). The evening drop in temperature is one of the natural triggers of sleep, and heavy bedding fights it.

Do this tonight. Trade one heavy layer for a lighter one, or leave your feet free of the covers, and let your body find its cooler set point.

Habit 12: Avoid sleeping face-down on your stomach

The Sunnah. It is reported that the Prophet ﷺ saw a man lying on his stomach and told him this was a manner of lying that Allah does not love, guiding him instead to his side or back. Because the strength of this narration is debated among scholars, take it as a gentle prophetic preference rather than a firm command, and confirm it before relying on it.

The Science. Sleep science does not single out the prone position, so the pairing here is a general one: honoring the body means choosing the posture that lets it breathe and rest easily through the night rather than one that strains it. Comfortable, unobstructed breathing supports unbroken sleep (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

Do this tonight. If you tend to sleep face-down, start the night on your side instead, in keeping with the prophetic preference.

Habit 13: Reserve the bed for sleep

The Sunnah. The Qur'an names the night a covering and sleep a rest, giving the night its own purpose distinct from the day's work. The bed, in that light, is a place set aside for rest, not a second desk or a screen-lit lounge.

The Science. One of the strongest behavioral cures for poor sleep is to keep the bed for sleep alone, so the brain builds a clean association between that place and rest. Working, worrying, and scrolling in bed teach

the mind to stay alert there, weakening the very cue you need (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13; Appendix Tip 10). Guard what the bed means to your brain.

Do this tonight. Do your working and your scrolling somewhere else, and let the bed be a place your mind knows only for sleep.

Section Three: Light & the Screen

The thief of the night, and how the Sunnah closes the door on it

The single largest change between the Prophet's ﷺ night and ours is light. He closed the day in darkness lit by a small flame he was told to put out; we bathe the final hour in bright, blue-white screens. The Sunnah's instinct to dim and extinguish the night maps almost exactly onto what science now urges.

Habit 14: Extinguish the lights and sleep in the dark

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ instructed that the lamps and fires be put out before sleeping, along with closing doors and covering vessels, when you go to bed. The night was to be darkened.

The Science. Darkness is what tells the brain to release melatonin, the hormone that times the onset of sleep. Even faint light interferes: as little as eight to ten lux, dimmer than most bedside lamps, is enough to delay melatonin release, and ordinary dim evening room light can suppress it by around half (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). Full darkness is not a luxury; it is a signal the body is waiting for.

Do this tonight. Put out every light, cover the small glows of standby lamps and chargers, and sleep in genuine darkness.

Habit 15: Put the screen down an hour before bed

The Sunnah. The dislike of wakeful, idle activity after Isha covers, in spirit, the modern habit of carrying a bright screen into the last hour of the night. The prophetic instinct was to let the night quiet down, not light up.

The Science. Screens are the worst offenders because the blue LED light they emit suppresses melatonin at roughly twice the rate of warm light at the same brightness (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13). In one study, reading on a bright tablet for a couple of hours before bed cut melatonin by around twenty-three percent and pushed its release later, with the effects lingering for days afterward, a kind of digital hangover (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13).

Do this tonight. Set a “screens down” time roughly an hour before bed and let the phone charge in another room.

Habit 16: Keep devices out of the bed

The Sunnah. Guarding the last hour of the night is an act of the will, a small discipline of the nafs that would rather have one more scroll. The Prophet ﷺ modeled a night given over to rest and remembrance, not restlessness.

The Science. Around ninety percent of people use an electronic device within the hour before bed, and the bed is the most common place they do it (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13). Keeping the device out of the bed removes both the light and the temptation, and protects the clean association between bed and sleep.

Do this tonight. Charge your phone across the room, not on the pillow, and buy a cheap alarm clock so the phone has no excuse to be near you.

Habit 17: Dim and warm the evening light

The Sunnah. The prophetic night was lit, when at all, by a low flame soon extinguished, not by bright overhead light. Lowering the light as the night deepened was simply how the world worked, and the Sunnah worked with it.

The Science. Evening artificial light can delay the internal clock by two to three hours a night by holding back melatonin, and even ordinary indoor evening light, around two hundred lux, produces roughly half of the maximum suppression (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13). Dimmer and warmer light in the last hour lets the clock run on time.

Do this tonight. In the final hour, switch off the bright overheads and use low, warm lamps instead. Let the room grow dim the way the evening does.

Habit 18: Recite Ayat al-Kursi as your night's guard

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ taught that whoever recites Ayat al-Kursi, the verse of the Throne, when he lies down will have a protector from Allah through the night and no devil will come near him until morning.

The Science. The protection is real, and it is from Allah; the calm that comes with it is a mercy that rides alongside. A heart that trusts its Guard can stop keeping watch, and sleep science recognizes the shape of that release from its own side: reduced bedtime worry is one of the surest paths to faster, deeper sleep (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 8). To lie down watched over is to lie down able to let go.

Do this tonight. Recite Ayat al-Kursi as you settle, and let its promise of protection quiet the mind for sleep.

Habit 19: Seal the night with the last two ayat of al-Baqarah

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ said that whoever recites the last two verses of Surat al-Baqarah at night, they will be enough for him. He gave the believer a short, complete recitation to close the day.

The Science. Replacing a stimulating final input, the bright feed, the anxious scroll, with a calm and familiar one is exactly the substitution sleep science recommends for winding down; what you feed the mind in the last minutes shapes how quickly it releases into sleep (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13). A known, gentle recitation is the ideal last input.

Do this tonight. Make these two verses the last thing you recite before sleep, in place of one last look at the phone.

Habit 20: Blow the muawwidhat over yourself

The Sunnah. Each night the Prophet ﷺ would cup his hands, recite Surat al-Ikhlās and the two verses of refuge, al-Falaq and an-Nas, blow into his palms, and wipe them over as much of his body as he could reach, beginning with his head and face, repeating it three times.

The Science. A short, physical, always-in-the-same-order ritual is one of the most effective conditioned cues for sleep; the body learns that this sequence means rest is coming and begins to prepare (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 8). And this one lives in the body as much as on the tongue: the cup of the palms, the breath, the slow pass over the head and face and whatever the hands can reach. By the third pass, the body already knows what comes next.

Do this tonight. Cup your hands, recite the three suras, blow into your palms, and wipe them over yourself three times as the last act of your night.

Section Four: The Rhythm of the Week

Regularity as worship, and the steady clock the body runs on

The believer's week already has a rhythm built into it: five prayers a day, a fixed dawn, a weekly gathering. Sleep science has landed on the same principle as its first and strongest advice. Regularity, more than any single trick, is what steadies the night.

Habit 21: Wake at the same time every day

The Sunnah. Fajr anchors the believer's day to a fixed dawn. The Prophet ﷺ prayed for barakah to be placed in the early mornings of his ummah, tying the start of the day to a set and blessed hour.

The Science. A fixed wake time, kept every day including weekends, is the single most effective piece of sleep advice there is and the first-line treatment for insomnia (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Appendix Tip 1). A steady wake time is what holds the whole internal clock in place, and the clock in turn governs alertness, mood, and sleep itself (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch2).

Do this tonight. Set one wake time you will honor every day of the week, and let Fajr be its anchor.

Habit 22: Don't try to bank weekend catch-up sleep

The Sunnah. The five daily prayers train the believer in steadiness rather than binges of devotion; the Prophet ﷺ taught that the most beloved deeds to Allah are the ones done consistently, even if small. That same steadiness serves the body.

The Science. Sleeping in on the weekend does not repay the sleep lost during the week, and it makes the following waking harder by shifting the clock later, so Monday feels like jet lag you gave yourself (Walker, *Why*

We Sleep, Appendix Tip 1). The debt is not settled by a lie-in; it is only deepened by the disruption.

Do this tonight. Resist the weekend sleep-in. Keep your wake time steady across all seven days and get your sleep by going to bed earlier, not by rising later.

Habit 23: Rise on the first waking, skip the snooze

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ taught the believer to wake with gratitude, praising Allah who gave life back after a sleep that resembles death, and to rise for the dawn. Waking was met with remembrance and movement, not delay.

The Science. The snooze button subjects the body to repeated jolts of the stress response, spiking heart rate and blood pressure again and again in the fragile minutes of waking; rising once, cleanly, spares you those repeated shocks (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). A single clean waking is gentler on the body than a dozen false starts.

Do this tonight. Set one alarm, place it across the room, and when it sounds, get up on the first call with a word of gratitude.

Habit 24: Cut caffeine after the early afternoon

The Sunnah. This sits under the principle of moderation and of guarding worship: nothing that quietly robs you of the night and the strength to rise for it should be taken lightly. The Prophet ﷺ taught balance in all the body's appetites.

The Science. Caffeine has a half-life of five to seven hours and can take up to eight or more to fully clear, and it works by blocking the very adenosine signal that makes you feel sleepy, masking your tiredness without removing it (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch2; Appendix Tip 3). An afternoon coffee is still circulating in your blood at bedtime.

Do this tonight. Draw a line in the early afternoon after which you take no caffeine, and watch for the hidden sources in tea, chocolate, and soft drinks.

Habit 25: Keep the night clear of intoxicants

The Sunnah. Intoxicants are forbidden in the Qur'an, named as defilement from the work of the devil to be avoided. The believer's night is already clear of the nightcap the wider culture reaches for.

The Science. Alcohol is a sedative, not a sleep aid, and the two are not the same; it fragments sleep into shallow, broken pieces and is one of the most powerful suppressors of REM sleep, the stage that repairs the emotions and consolidates learning (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13). What feels like being knocked out is the opposite of rest.

Do this tonight. Take quiet confidence that the prohibition already guards your nights, and let nothing intoxicating stand between you and true sleep.

Habit 26: Move by day, not in the last hours before bed

The Sunnah. The prophetic life was an active one, walked and worked and physically engaged, and the body's exertion belonged to the daylight. Rest belonged to the night. The body has a right of activity and a right of rest, and both were honored in their season.

The Science. Regular exercise improves sleep, but not when it runs too close to bedtime; vigorous activity in the final two to three hours before sleep raises core temperature and alertness when both should be falling (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Appendix Tip 2). Move earlier, and let the evening be for cooling and quiet.

Do this tonight. Get your real exertion done in daylight or early evening, and keep the final hours before bed calm and still.

Habit 27: Get morning daylight

The Sunnah. Rising for Fajr and being awake in the blessed early morning places the believer in the first light of the day, exactly when the body most needs it. The Prophet ﷺ asked Allah to bless those early hours.

The Science. Morning light is the master reset for the internal clock. Getting daylight, ideally thirty minutes or more, in the first part of the day sets the clock forward on time and strengthens the night's melatonin release later (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch2; Appendix Tip 11). The morning light is what tells the body when night will come.

Do this tonight. Plan to step outside soon after you wake, and let real daylight, not a lamp, start your day.

Habit 28: Protect a full seven-to-nine-hour window

The Sunnah. Salman said to Abu al-Darda, who was exhausting himself in constant worship, that his body had a right over him, his eyes had a right over him, and his family had a right over him, giving each its due; and the Prophet ﷺ affirmed that Salman had spoken the truth. Sleep is one of those rights, not a theft from worship but a support of it.

The Science. The costs of short sleep are steep and well documented. After roughly nineteen to twenty-two hours awake, a person is as cognitively impaired as someone legally drunk; a single night cut to four hours can drop the activity of the immune system's natural-killer cells by around seventy percent; and short sleep raises the risk of heart disease, stroke, diabetes, and worse (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch7/8). The body was not built to run on the scraps we give it.

Do this tonight. Count back seven to nine hours from your fixed wake time, and treat that bedtime as a boundary, not a suggestion.

Section Five: Rising in the Last Third

The nap that carries you, the du'a on your lips, and the pre-dawn hour

The prophetic night was built to turn toward its end. The believer sleeps not to escape the night but to be able to meet its most precious hours, when Allah descends to the lowest heaven and the world is quiet enough to hear yourself pray.

Habit 29: Take the midday nap (qaylulah)

The Sunnah. The midday nap, the qaylulah, was the practice of the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions, who would rest briefly around the middle of the day. A narration also encourages taking the midday rest; because its wording and strength are discussed among scholars, treat the practice as well-established while confirming any specific narration you cite.

The Science. Human beings are naturally biphasic sleepers, wired for a long night and a short afternoon rest, driven by a hardwired dip in alertness in the middle of the afternoon (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch4). A short nap restores you: a NASA study found a nap of around twenty-six minutes improved performance by thirty-four percent and alertness by over fifty percent (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch7). And in a Greek study, people who gave up their regular siesta saw a striking rise in cardiac death risk over the following years (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch4).

Do this tonight. Plan tomorrow's qaylulah: a short midday rest, in the tradition of the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions.

Habit 30: Keep the nap short and before mid-afternoon

The Sunnah. The qaylulah of the Companions was a brief midday pause, not a long afternoon sleep. Its very name and timing tie it to the middle of the day, before the afternoon runs long.

The Science. Naps help, but timing and length matter. A nap taken after mid-afternoon bleeds off the sleep pressure you need to fall asleep at night, and a nap kept short avoids the grogginess of waking from deep sleep (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Appendix Tip 7). The right nap supports the night; the wrong one steals from it.

Do this tonight. If you nap, keep it short, around twenty to thirty minutes, and take it before mid-afternoon so it does not rob your night.

Habit 31: Sleep with your heart set on the last third

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ said that our Lord descends each night to the lowest heaven when the last third of the night remains, saying: who is calling on Me that I may answer him, who is asking of Me that I may give him, who is seeking My forgiveness that I may forgive him. The night bends toward that hour.

The Science. Sleeping early front-loads the deepest, most restorative slow-wave sleep into the first half of the night, which is precisely what makes it possible to wake refreshed in the pre-dawn hours rather than dragging yourself up mid-cycle (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch2/3). An early night is what makes the last third reachable.

Do this tonight. Go to sleep early with the intention to rise, even for a few minutes, in the last third, and let that intention shape your bedtime.

Habit 32: Say the sleeping du'a as your last words

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ would say on lying down, “In Your name, O Allah, I die and I live,” and taught that the believer place his final words of the day in remembrance and submission, so that if he dies in his sleep he dies upon the fitrah.

The Science. Sleep and death share a doorway in the Qur'an, which calls sleep a kind of taking of the soul; science, in its own register, finds that each night's sleep is a genuine restoration and repair, a small renewal the

body cannot live without (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch6/8). To hand the night over with those words is to rest in the trust that runs through both.

Do this tonight. Let the sleeping du'a be the last thing on your tongue, so remembrance is where your day ends and, if Allah wills, where it begins again.

Habit 33: Wake gently for tahajjud

The Sunnah. When the Prophet ﷺ rose in the night he would wipe the sleep from his face, look to the sky, and recite the closing verses of Surat Al Imran before turning to his prayer. He rose slowly, into wakefulness and remembrance, not with a jolt.

The Science. Waking naturally and easing into alertness spares the body the abrupt stress-spike of a jarring alarm (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). A gentle rising, met with a few settled gestures before any demand, is kinder to the waking brain and easier to sustain night after night.

Do this tonight. If you rise for qiyam, wake gently: sit up, wipe your face, look up, and let your first moments be quiet before you stand to pray.

Habit 34: Reach for the siwak on waking

The Sunnah. Whenever the Prophet ﷺ rose in the night, he would clean his mouth thoroughly with the siwak before anything else. The tooth-stick was his companion at every waking.

The Science. This pairs under the general principle rather than a specific finding: a small, physical, cleansing act on waking helps the body cross from sleep into alertness, one more familiar cue that the waking part of the day has begun (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). A fresh mouth is a gentle nudge into the day.

Do this tonight. Keep a siwak, or at least a brush, within reach of the bed, and make cleaning your mouth the first thing you do on waking.

Habit 35: If sleep flees, rise and turn to remembrance

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ taught that whoever wakes in the night and says the words of tawhid and praise, then asks forgiveness or prays, will have his prayer answered and his prayer accepted. Wakefulness in the night was turned toward Allah, not toward frustration.

The Science. Lying in bed awake and frustrated teaches the brain to associate the bed with wakefulness; the standard advice is that if you cannot sleep after around twenty minutes, get up, do something calm in dim light, and return only when sleepy (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Appendix Tip 12). Do not fight the bed. Rise, settle, and come back.

Do this tonight. If sleep will not come, do not lie there straining. Get up, turn to quiet remembrance, and return to bed only when your eyes grow heavy.

Section Six: The Family Night

The household at rest, from the youngest to the oldest

You know the other version of this night: one child still not in bed, a sink half full of dishes, a work message answered with half a heart, and everyone finally asleep in a house that never actually closed. A home has a night of its own. The Prophet ﷺ closed his household for the night with care, taught the young their bedtime words, and moved through the evening with gentleness. A peaceful house is where peaceful sleep begins.

Habit 36: Close the house for the night

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ instructed that at nightfall you bring in the children, close the doors and mention Allah's name, cover the vessels and mention Allah's name, and put out the lamps, giving the whole house a settled close to the day.

The Science. A dark, quiet, safe, and orderly sleeping environment is one of the foundations of good sleep for everyone under the roof, and small disturbances of light and noise fragment the night for the whole household (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13). Closing the house is a nightly ritual that protects everyone's rest at once.

Do this tonight. Make a small nightly round: gather the children, lower the lights, secure the doors, and let the whole house know the day is done.

Habit 37: Tuck the children in with the Sunnah

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ was tender with children and taught the household its bedtime protections, blowing the verses of refuge over his family and teaching the young the remembrances of sleep. The night was a place to pass the Sunnah on, gently.

The Science. Children's sleep has been quietly eroded; children today sleep on the order of two hours less per night than they did a century ago, and protecting their sleep supports the brain maturation and pruning that deep sleep drives in the young (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch15/5). A calm, consistent bedtime is one of the greatest gifts a parent gives a growing brain.

Do this tonight. Make your children's bedtime unhurried and consistent: the adhkar, the verses of refuge, a calm word, and lights out at a steady hour.

Habit 38: Honor the teenager's later clock

The Sunnah. Gentleness and mercy in dealing with the family were the Prophet's ﷺ way; he was never harsh where understanding would serve. Meeting a young person's real needs with *rifq*, gentleness, rather than rebuke, is part of that.

The Science. A teenager's internal clock genuinely shifts later during adolescence; it is biology, not laziness. Where schools have honored this with later start times, the results have been dramatic, including steep drops in teen car crashes after start times were pushed back (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch5/15). Understanding the teen's clock is mercy grounded in fact.

Do this tonight. Ease the pressure on a teenager's night with understanding rather than blame, and protect their morning sleep where you can, especially before demanding days.

Habit 39: Greet the morning with gratitude

The Sunnah. On waking, the Prophet ﷺ would say, "All praise is for Allah who gave us life after He caused us to die, and to Him is the return," meeting the new day with thankfulness before anything else.

The Science. A consistent, positive morning ritual reinforces a steady wake time, and the steadiness of that wake time is the anchor that holds the whole sleep-wake rhythm in place for the day and the night to come (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch2; Appendix Tip 1). How you meet the morning shapes the night that follows it.

Do this tonight. Prepare to make gratitude your first waking thought, and let the household hear the day begin with thanks rather than complaint.

Habit 40: Let the household's night be gentle and shared

The Sunnah. The Prophet ﷺ shared the evening with his family, spoke kindly, and taught even the labor of the home to be closed with remembrance, as he taught Ali and Fatima the tasbeih of the night. The home at night was a place of gentleness and shared devotion.

The Science. REM sleep is the brain's overnight emotional first aid, softening the sharp edges of the day and restoring calm; a peaceful, unstrained evening lets everyone reach that repair rather than carrying the day's tension into the dark (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch7/10/11). A gentle night heals more than the body.

Do this tonight. Let your household's last hour be soft: kind words, no unfinished arguments carried to bed, and a shared quiet that lets everyone sleep in peace.

Your Prophetic Night at a Glance

A one-page checklist. You do not need all forty at once. Begin with three.

As the evening winds down - [] Pray Isha and head toward bed within the hour - [] Trade screens and idle talk for quiet remembrance in the last hour - [] Finish your last real meal well before bed - [] Dim and warm the lights; put out the bright overheads

As you prepare the room and body - [] Take a warm wash, then let the room run cool - [] Cool room, lighter bedding, feet free to vent heat - [] Charge the phone in another room; keep the bed for sleep

As you make wudu and lie down - [] Perform wudu as for prayer - [] Dust off the bed, say bismillah - [] Lie on your right side, hand under your cheek - [] Recite Ayat al-Kursi - [] Recite the last two ayat of al-Baqarah - [] Cup and blow the three suras, wipe over yourself three times - [] Close with the sleeping du'a as your last words

Across the week - [] One fixed wake time, all seven days, anchored to Fajr - [] No weekend catch-up sleep; no snooze - [] No caffeine after early afternoon - [] Real movement by day, calm in the final hours - [] Morning daylight soon after waking - [] A short qaylulah before mid-afternoon - [] Protect a seven-to-nine-hour window

Toward the last third - [] Sleep early, heart set on rising - [] Wake gently; siwak first; wipe the face, look up - [] If sleep flees, rise to remembrance, return when heavy - [] Greet the morning with gratitude

For the household - [] Close the house: children in, doors closed, lamps out, names of Allah said - [] Tuck the children in with the adhkar - [] Honor the teenager's later clock with mercy - [] Keep the last hour of the home gentle and shared

The first night. Do not wait for the week you feel ready. Tonight, pray Isha and head for bed, leave the phone charging in another room, make wudu, and lie down on your right side with the du'a on your tongue. That is four of the forty before midnight, and the rest will follow the way habits follow, one quiet night at a time. May every one of them be counted, if Allah wills, as a night lived the way His Prophet ﷺ lived it.

References and a Note on Sources

On the science. The scientific findings in this book are drawn from a single source, Matthew Walker's *Why We Sleep* (Scribner, 2017), used as cited facts and findings and rewritten entirely in DailySunnah's own words. No passage of Walker's text is reproduced. Facts are cited inline by chapter. The chapters drawn on:

- **Ch2:** the circadian clock, adenosine and sleep pressure, melatonin timing, caffeine's half-life and mechanism.
- **Ch3:** sleep architecture and the front-loading of deep sleep in the early night.
- **Ch4:** biphasic sleep, the qaylulah / siesta, the afternoon alertness dip, and the universality of sleep.
- **Ch5:** sleep across the lifespan; the genuine later shift of the adolescent clock; deep sleep and brain maturation.

- **Ch6:** deep NREM sleep and memory consolidation.
- **Ch7:** sleep deprivation, cognitive impairment equivalent to intoxication, the NASA nap finding, the amygdala's emotional reactivity.
- **Ch8:** the glymphatic system and brain-cleansing, immune function, and the disease costs of short sleep.
- **Ch10 / Ch11:** REM sleep as overnight emotional restoration.
- **Ch13:** light and melatonin suppression, screens and blue light, temperature and the warm-bath effect, alcohol, and behavioral sleep hygiene.
- **Ch15:** sleep across society, children's shrinking sleep, later school start times.
- **Appendix:** Walker's twelve tips for healthy sleep (via NIH MedlinePlus): fixed schedule, exercise timing, caffeine and nicotine, alcohol, late meals, sleep-disrupting medications, nap timing, pre-bed relaxation, the hot bath, a dark and cool gadget-free room, daylight exposure, and not lying awake in bed.

Statistics pending verification. Every load-bearing number in this book is marked in the text with and must be re-confirmed against the print edition of *Why We Sleep* before publication.

On the scripture, the DailySunnah citation gate. Every Qur'anic verse and every hadith in this book is marked in the text with and is PENDING the standard DailySunnah human citation gate. Nothing is considered confirmed until a human reviewer verifies the reference, the wording, and, for hadith, the grading against sunnah.com and the Qur'an against quran.com. Where a narration's authenticity is discussed among scholars, it has been described gently and flagged for that reason rather than asserted, and any habit for which no specific narration exists has been framed under a general Islamic principle rather than tied to a source. No hadith has been invented, paraphrased into existence, or assigned a grading in this draft.

The Prophetic Night. May Allah make our nights a mercy, our sleep a rest, and our rising a return to Him. Ameen.
